including promoting both the universal ratification and implementation of the major human rights treaties and respect for the rule of law.

Mandate

The Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights (OHCHR) is mandated to promote and protect the enjoyment and full realization, by all people, of all rights established in the Charter of the United Nations and in international human rights laws and treaties. OHCHR is guided in its work by the mandate provided by the General Assembly in resolution 48/141, the Charter of the United Nations, the Universal Declaration of Human Rights and subsequent human rights instruments, the Vienna Declaration and Programme of Action, the 1993 World Conference on Human Rights, and the 2005 World Summit Outcome Document.

The OHCHR mandate upholds the broad principles of preventing human rights violations, securing respect for all human rights, promoting international cooperation in protecting human rights, coordinating related activities throughout the United Nations, and strengthening the United Nations activities in the field of human rights. The OHCHR also makes efforts to integrate a human rights approach within all work carried out by the United Nations agencies.

Mission Statement

The mission of the OHCHR is to work for the protection of all human rights for all people; to help empower people to realize their rights; and to assist those responsible for upholding such rights in ensuring that they are implemented.

In carrying out its mission, OHCHR:

- Gives priority to addressing the most pressing human rights violations, both acute and chronic, particularly those that put life in imminent peril.
- Focuses attention on those who are at risk and vulnerable on multiple fronts.
- Pays equal attention to the realization of civil, cultural,